

**THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS**

MSBA7041 — Artificial Intelligence Generated Content in Business
Dr. Dawei WANG

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Dr. Dawei WANG
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Consultation times: By appointment

Tutor: Zikang Dai (Ken)
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Consultation times: By appointment

Course website: Moodle (<https://moodle.hku.hk>)

Programming languages: No prerequisites and programming language needed

Recommended book 1: Herbert Simon (1996). *The Sciences of The Artificial*. The MIT Press

Recommended book 2: Julio Ottino (2022). *The Nexus: Augmented Thinking for a Complex World*. The MIT Press.

Recommended book 3: Christopher Miller (2022). *Chip War: The Fight for The World's Most Critical Technology*. Simon and Schuster

Recommended book 4: Karen Hao (2025). *Empire of AI: Dreams and Nightmares in Sam Altman's OpenAI*. Penguin Press.

Recommended Article 1: Bender, E. M., Gebru, T., McMillan-Major, A., & Shmitchell, S. (2021). On the dangers of stochastic parrots: Can language models be too big? *Proceedings of the 2021 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '21)*, 610–623.

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3442188.3445922>

Recommended Article 2: Wang, D., Huang, D., Shen, H., & Uzzi, B. (2025). A large-scale comparison of divergent creativity in humans and large language models. *Nature Human Behaviour*.

<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-025-02331-1>

Recommended Article 3: Thornhill-Miller, B., Camarda, A., Mercier, M., Burkhardt, J.-M., Morisseau, T., Bourgeois-Bougrine, S., Vinchon, F., El Hayek, S., Augereau-Landais, M., Mourey, F., Feybesse, C., Sundquist, D., & Lubart, T. (2023). Creativity, critical thinking, communication, and collaboration: Assessment, certification, and promotion of 21st century skills for the future of work and education. *Journal of Intelligence*, 11(3), Article 54. <https://doi.org/10.3390/jintelligence11030054>

Recommended Article 4: Vaswani, A., Shazeer, N., Parmar, N., Uszkoreit, J., Jones, L., Gomez, A. N., Kaiser, Ł., & Polosukhin, I. (2017). *Attention is all you need*. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, 30. <https://arxiv.org/abs/1706.03762>

Recommended Article 5: Koe, D. (2026, January 10). *If you have multiple interests, do not waste the next 2–3 years*. future/proof. <https://letters.thedankoe.com/p/if-you-have-multiple-interests-do>

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Generative Artificial intelligence (GenAI) represents a revolutionary technology, with some claiming that it is almost akin to the discovery of fire in the early stages of human civilization. It promises to serve as a multifaceted tool potentially capable of generating novel content, solving problems, predicting outcomes, automating operations, and boosting productivity.

This course requires no prerequisites or technical background and is tailored for students who aspire to learn about (1) how to transform existing workflows and (2) what is the “full-stack” of GenAI, i.e., from its development, application and deployment to its implications in real-world settings. The curriculum begins with a comprehensive overview of the infrastructure (or *development*) of GenAI—covering basic concepts of software, hardware, data, and networks of GenAI—and compares these elements to human cognition, brain and psychology. Students will get to learn and apply these concepts through a proprietary in-class exercise developed specifically for this course, called “*Beat The Bot*”.

Subsequently, students will explore various *applications* of GenAI, by learning about GenAI tools used in the production of text, code, image and video generation. During the discussion of applications, students will learn AI workflow tools such as Zapier and n8n as well as real business cases that are developed specifically for the course. The course ends with students learning about the societal *implications* of GenAI, touching briefly on the environmental, societal and governance (ESG) of GenAI.

This is an interactive and hands-on course that includes in-class exercises, invited guest speakers, case and workflow or AI platform demonstrations, individual assignment, group discussions, and a group project. Students are expected to come with an open-mind and participate actively in class. By the end, not only will students be skilled in identifying viable applications, assessing opportunities, and recognizing obstacles of GenAI, but also gain a deeper understanding of their own intelligence and generative-ness.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

- CO1: Understand the development of GenAI is the cumulation of software, hardware and data.
- CO2: Compare the capability of GenAI to human intelligence, brain and psychology including the students.
- CO3: Learn the application of GenAI in text, code, image and video generation.
- CO4: Understand how deployment and application of GenAI is affected by people.
- CO5: Comprehend the implications of GenAI using the environment, social and governance framework.

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

- PLO1: Acquisition of knowledge of the discipline
- PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge
- PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership
- PLO4: Developing global outlook
- PLO5: Mastering communication skills

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes

**Aligned Programme
Learning Outcomes**

CLO1: Develop understanding of the different businesses and sectors of GenAI. CLO2: Compare GenAI to the student's and other people's human intelligence. CLO3: Master leading all aspects of GenAI in a "full stack" manner. CLO4: Understand the societal and ethical implications of GenAI.	PLO1, PLO2, PLO4 PLO1, PLO2, PLO3 PLO3, PLO4, PLO5 PLO3, PLO5
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COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	Contact Duration	Study Load in Percentage of Study
T&L1. Interactive lectures	20 hours	17%
T&L2. In-class discussions and activities	10 hours	8%
T&L3. Assignments & group projects	60 hours	50%
T&L4. Lecture preparation & self-study	30 hours	25%

COURSE ASSESSMENTS

Assessment Methods	Assessment Period or Due Date	Weight in Percentage	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
Class attendance	From Class 3 to Class 10	5%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
Online participation	From Class 3 to Class 9	10%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
In-class participation	From Class 3 to Class 9	5%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
Mid-term examination	On 19/4/2026	20%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
Individual assignment P1	On Class 5	5%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
Individual assignment P2	On Class 9	30%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
Group presentation	On Class 10	25%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4

COURSE CONTENT AND TEACHING SCHEDULE

Class 1: Course and topic introduction + Evolution of Intelligence
 Class 2: "Beat the Bot" exercise + Individual assignment discussion
 Class 3: Text generation + "Zapier" workflow demo
 Class 4: Code generation+ "N8N" workflow demo + Group project discussion
 Class 5: Image generation + "Tapnow" workflow demo
 Class 6: AI development — Software + Hardware + Data
 Class 7: CDE Framework + Group project workshop
 Mid-term Examination
 Class 8: Guest speaker "Beyond the Hype: Practical Realities of AI Adoption"
 Class 9: Environmental, social and governance of GenAI
 Class 10: Group presentation and awards ceremony

PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

Conduct pre-term, mid-term and final surveys using Google Forms and provide response to student feedback.

COURSE POLICY

An orderly learning environment is extremely important for this course. Disruptive behaviors are absolutely unacceptable. Academic dishonesty includes cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, use of generative artificial intelligence in the writing of assignments and reports unless otherwise permitted by the assignment or report, falsifying academic records, and any act designed to avoid participating honestly in the learning process. Any such dishonesty will result in an F grade.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION

Assignments will be submitted on Moodle. No late assignment will be accepted. Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle.

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

Course Grade Descriptors

A+, A, A-	Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge Handling questions professionally High participation in discussions Present arguments that have an element of originality Excellent performance in assignments
B+, B, B-	Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge Handling questions in a logical way Good participation in discussions Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook Good performance in assignments
C+, C, C-	Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved Fairly address questions as set Some participation in discussions Present arguments in a well-structure manner Acceptable performance in assignments
D+, D	Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved Barely address questions as set Minimal or no participation in discussions Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner Marginally acceptable performance in assignments
F	Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved Unable or unwilling to handle questions Minimal or no participation in discussions Present arguments poorly Poorly performance in assignments

Assessment Rubrics for Participation

A+, A, A-	High participation in discussions Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge Handling questions professionally Present arguments that have an element of originality Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
B+, B, B-	Good participation in discussions Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge Handling questions in a logical way Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
C+, C, C-	Some participation in discussions Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved Fairly address questions as set Present arguments in a well-structure manner Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
D+, D	Minimal or no participation in discussions Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved Barely address questions as set Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone)
F	Minimal or no participation in discussions

	Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved Unable or unwilling to handle questions Present arguments poorly Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late)
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